



A JRPG MASTERCLASS

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Full disclosure, I haven't played any Persona games before this one. I know I know, as an ardent RPG fan it's one of my biggest shames. There were many reasons the Persona franchise eluded me; for starters they were limited to consoles for the longest time, and second, I'm a bit of a stickler when it comes to chronology. All that being said, after playing Persona 5 Royal I'm seriously kicking myself for not picking the franchise up sooner. This is without a doubt, a masterclass in turn-based JRPG. So if you're a fan of the genre and the franchise in general, this is probably all you need to get your hands on Perso-

na 5 Royal. If not, well read on for the full review and I might just convince you.

WHAT'S NEW?

We were initially confused about Persona 5 Royal, because we thought Persona 5 released back in 2017 (forgive us, first Persona game and all that). Turns out, Persona 5 Royal is an expansion to the existing game. The original Persona 5 was already pretty massive. Persona 5 Royal brings in even more content, including the addition of two new Confidants (two more companion NPCs that you can interact with). We'll avoid mentioning names here because, spoilers. Other than that, the majority of the con-

tent seems to have been added after the final dungeon of Persona 5. There's also a bunch of new activities that can be done to improve your teamwork and new ways to improve your stats. Even the Palaces (Persona's version of dungeons) have been revamped with new elements. These include a grappling hook for Joker (our protagonist) to get around, and the presence of Will Seeds in dungeons. Each Palace now has three Will Seeds in them, and if all three are found they can be combined to create powerful accessories. That about covers everything new here. There's also the Thieves Guild stuff but we didn't really spend a lot of time with that.